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MENG XU

US Citizen

Department of Management, Terry College of Business, University of Georgia
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EDUCATION

The University of Georgia, Terry College of Business
PhD in Strategy and Entrepreneurship *Expected 2028*

Georgia Institute of Technology, Scheller College of Business
MBA, Business Analytics 2020

The University of Georgia, Terry College of Business
BBA in Risk Management and Insurance 2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study how firms and managers are evaluated under uncertainty by multiple stakeholders, how they interpret and respond to these evaluations, and how these processes shape strategic decision-making and organizational outcomes. I also conduct methods research that develops and evaluates new empirical approaches for strategy research.

Behavioral strategy; corporate governance; research methods

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

Xu, M., Blagoeva, R., Benischke, M., & Withers. **CEO power and job protection**. 1st R&R at *Organization Science*.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

AI and Evaluation. With Graffin, S. Writing in progress. Target journal: *Strategic Management Journal*

Succession planning and firm competitive dynamics. With Lee, E., Maich, K., & Graffin, S. Data analysis in progress. Target journal: *Strategic Management Journal*

Machine learning synthetic data method. With Arjmandi, H., Quigley, T., & Hyde, S. Data analysis in progress. Target journal: *Strategic Management Journal*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Xu, M. & Graffin, S. From Conference Calls to Common Ground: How AI Summaries Shape Analyst Evaluation. *Oxford University Centre for Corporate Reputation Symposium.* Oxford, UK, 2026

- *Selected to present at the Emerging Scholar session*

Xu, M., Herat, H., Hyde, S., & Quigley, T. The Machine Learning Data Dilemma in Strategy Research: Building Reliable Models Without Consuming All Data. *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA, 2025

- *Nominated for SMS Annual Conference Research Methods Paper Prize*

Lee, E., **Xu, M.**, Quigley, T., & Graffin, S. Crisis vs. Ordinary Succession: Toward a Multidimensional View of CEO Succession Planning. *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA, 2025

Xu, M., Blagoeva, R., Benischke, M., & Withers, M. From Power to Influence: How CEO Power and Personality Configurations Prevent Dismissal. *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Copenhagen, Denmark, 2025

Lee, E., **Xu, M.**, Quigley, T., & Graffin, S. Crisis vs. Ordinary Succession: Toward a Multidimensional View of CEO Succession Planning. *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Copenhagen, Denmark, 2025

Xu, M., Blagoeva, R., Benischke, M., & Withers, M. From Potential to Materialization: The Configurational Effect of CEO Power and Personality on CEO Non-dismissal. *International Corporate Governance Society Annual Conference*, Tempe, AZ, 2024

Xu, M., Blagoeva, R., Benischke, M., & Withers, M. From Potential to Materialization: The Configurational Effect of CEO Power and Personality on CEO Non-dismissal. *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*, Istanbul, Turkey, 2024

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

Teaching Strategies for PhD Students. GRSC 7770 Graduate Teaching Seminar, University of Georgia, Spring 2026

SELECTED WORKSHOPS

SMS Doctoral Workshop. SMS, 2026

Junior Scholar Professional Development Workshop. Oxford Corporate Reputation Symposium, 2026

STR Managing Your Dissertation Workshop. AOM, 2026

SL&G Paper Development Workshop. SMS, 2024, 2025

OMT PhD Student Professional Development Workshop. AOM, 2025

Paper Development Workshop. ICGS, 2024

QCA Professional Development Workshop. AOM, 2024

AMJ Paper Development Workshop. AOM, 2023

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal Reviewing

Ad hoc Reviewer, Strategic Management Journal, 2026 – present

Conference Reviewing

Conference Reviewer, SMS (2026 – present), AOM (2024 – present), and ICGS (2024)

Conference Service
Organizer. PhD Circle LIVE Student Networking Lunch. *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*, Berlin, Germany, 2026

Panelist. First-Time SMS Attendee Workshop. *Strategic Management Society.* 2026

Organizer. Machine Learning Across Methods: Expanding What Strategy Research Can Measure, Explain, and Theorize. *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Philadelphia, PA, 2026

Organizer and Moderator. Oxford-Style Debate: Do Boards Have the Capabilities to Effectively Manage CEO Succession? *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Philadelphia, PA, 2026

Organizer. PhD Circle LIVE Student Networking Lunch. *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA, 2025

Organizer. PhD Student Coffee Meet-up. *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA, 2025

Moderator. What Happens Around Leadership Transitions? CEO Succession, Executive Profiles, and CEO Evaluations. *Academy of Management Annual Meeting*, Copenhagen, Denmark, 2025

Academic Society Service
PhD Circle Champion, SMS, 2025 – 2027

PhD Volunteer. SMS Berlin, 2026

PhD Representative, CARMA**,** 2025 – 2026

Ambassador, AOM STR Division**,** 2023 – 2024

GRANTS

UGA Graduate School Conference Travel Grants $1000, 2026

International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS) Doctoral Travel Grant $2000, 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

University of Georgia
MGMT 5560 International Strategic Management (Undergraduate), Fall 2025
- Average Rating: 4.9/5.0 (96% response rate)

Mercer University
BA 631 Visual Reporting and Communication (Graduate, M.S. in Business Analytics), Fall 2020
- Average Rating: 4.7/5.0 (100% response rate)

Teaching Assistant

University of Georgia
MGMT 3000 Principles of Management, Fall 2023 & Spring 2024

Georgia Institute of Technology
MGT 2210 Information Systems and Digital Transformation, Spring 2020

NON-ACADEMIC PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, Equifax, Atlanta GA, 2021 – 2022

Senior Marketing Strategy Analyst, UPS, Atlanta GA, 2020 – 2021

Account Executive, Builders, Atlanta GA, 2014 – 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Methods & Analytics: applied econometrics; machine learning; natural language processing; LLM-based modeling

Data Engineering & Scale: relational databases & querying; API integration; web crawling, scraping, & parsing; large-scale data processing (TB-scale); GPU-enabled computing

Programming, Platforms & Tools: Python; R; Stata; SQL; Shell; DuckDB; vLLM; CUDA; Tableau; Power BI